

Ecommerce Revenue Exposure & Payment Reconciliation Control

Executive summary

This ecommerce dataset initially appeared to support a standard order-status and sales dashboard. However, once order value was compared against recorded payment value, the main business issue shifted.

The dashboard shows **£34.40M recorded order value** against **£24.00M recorded payment value**, leaving a **net payment position of -£10.41M** and a **payment coverage rate of 69.75%**. The largest visible risk is not missing payment records, but payment values that do not reconcile to recorded order values.

In short: payment exists, but payment control is not yet visible.

34.40M Recorded Order Value	24.00M Recorded Payment Value	-10.41M Net Payment Position	69.75% Payment Coverage
21.33M Underpaid Exposure	10.92M Overpaid Exposure	20.98M Delivered Orders Underpaid	495.94K Paid Value Not Delivered

Business problem

For an ecommerce operation, order status alone is not enough to confirm revenue quality. An order may be delivered, shipped, cancelled, unavailable, invoiced or still processing. But from a finance perspective, the more important question is whether the payment value agrees with the value of the order.

- The dashboards were therefore designed to answer three executive questions:
- a. How much order value is supported by recorded payment value?
 - b. Where are underpaid or overpaid orders concentrated?
 - c. Which exceptions should finance investigate first?

Key findings from the management dashboard

The KPI section shows a material reconciliation concern:

KPI	Value
Recorded Order Value	£34.40M
Recorded Payment Value	£24.00M
Net Payment Position	- £10.41M
Payment Coverage	69.75%
Underpaid Exposure	£21.33M
Overpaid Exposure	£10.92M
Delivered Orders Underpaid	£20.98M
Paid Value Not Delivered	£495.94K

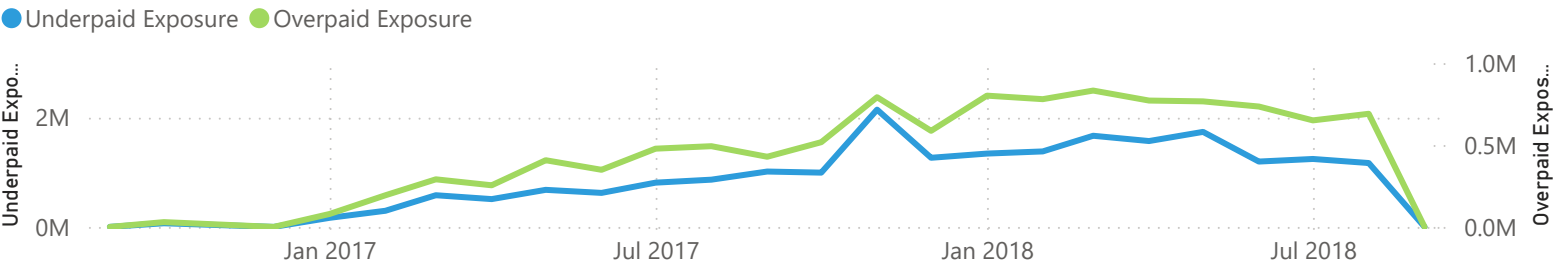
The most important figure is **£20.98M delivered orders underpaid**. This suggests that a significant value of orders marked as delivered have recorded payment values below order value.

This does not prove unpaid debt, fraud, failed collection or incorrect reporting on its own. It does show that the available dataset does not provide enough comfort that delivered order value and payment value reconcile cleanly. That is exactly the type of issue a CFO would need surfaced before trusting reported revenue.

Trend over time

The monthly trend shows both underpaid and overpaid values appearing across the order period, rather than as a single isolated exception. The visual on page 2 shows underpaid value rising through 2017, peaking around late 2017 / early 2018, then remaining material into 2018 before dropping at the end of the dataset period. This matters because it suggests the issue is not confined to one month, one failed upload, or one unusual operational incident. It appears to be a recurring pattern in the available data.

Underpaid Exposure and Overpaid Exposure by Order date



Order status and payment status

The finance matrix breaks the reconciliation issue down by order status and payment status.

- Delivered orders dominate the exposure. The matrix shows:
- **38,595 delivered orders** classified as overpaid, with **£10.69M overpaid value**
 - **48,832 delivered orders** classified as underpaid, with **£20.98M underpaid value**
 - only **1 delivered order** shown as matched

This is the central control issue.

If orders are marked as delivered, finance would normally expect payment, settlement, credit, refund or receivables logic to be traceable. In this dataset, that traceability is not visible.

Payment Status		Matched					Overpaid				
Order Status		# Orders	Underpaid Exposure	Overpaid Exposure	Recorded Payment Value	Recorded Order Value	# Orders	Underpaid Exposure	Overpaid Exposure	Recorded Payment Value	Recorded Order Value
▼											
⊕ unavailable							2	0.00	1,512.70	1,729.26	216.
⊖ shipped							406	0.00	124,762.93	186,981.13	62,218.
wallet							64	0.00	16,857.13	27,040.14	10,183.
voucher							22	0.00	5,155.02	9,119.92	3,964.
debit_card							6	0.00	1,064.51	2,220.22	1,155.
credit_card							314	0.00	101,686.27	148,600.85	46,914.
⊕ processing							127	0.00	33,359.61	50,070.21	16,710.
⊖ invoiced							125	0.00	38,064.90	55,153.50	17,088.
wallet							38	0.00	14,557.84	20,485.32	5,927.
voucher							7	0.00	3,250.37	4,794.81	1,544.
debit_card							2	0.00	730.54	1,357.70	627.
credit_card							78	0.00	19,526.15	28,515.67	8,989.
⊖ delivered		1	0.00	0.00	145.00	145.00	38595	0.00	10,686,241.47	16,505,580.11	5,819,338.
wallet							7421	0.00	2,006,859.62	3,165,350.88	1,158,491.
voucher							2052	0.00	782,319.45	1,116,823.87	334,504.
debit_card							543	0.00	135,902.97	212,131.66	76,228.
credit_card		1	0.00	0.00	145.00	145.00	28579	0.00	7,761,159.43	12,011,273.70	4,250,114.
⊕ canceled							185	0.00	33,230.28	58,159.07	24,928.
⊕ approved							2	0.00	1,139.60	1,641.94	502.
Total		1	0.00	0.00	145.00	145.00	39442	0.00	10,918,311.49	16,859,315.22	5,941,003.

Finance investigation view

The finance detail page supports investigation rather than executive summary. It shows individual order-level exceptions with fields including:

- Order ID
- Order status
- Customer state
- Recorded order value
- Recorded payment value
- Under/overpaid exposure
- Payment method
- Payment structure
- Number of instalments

The dashboard visuals below allow finance users to filter by order status, payment means, payment type and payment status. This makes the page useful for investigating specific exception groups rather than only viewing headline totals.

Example exceptions shown include delivered orders where total order value is materially higher than payment value. One visible example shows an order value of £6,738.82 and payment value of £65.48, producing a large underpaid position.

Order ID	Orderstatus	Customer State	Recorded Order Value	Recorded Payment Value	Payment Difference	Payment Method	Payment Structure	Instalments	Order Status	Payment Method
SwjsVBeUO9OM	delivered	SP	6,738.82	65.48	-6,673.34	credit_card	Instalments	2	☒ Deselect all	☒ Deselect all
aPnggTzFcusk	delivered	SP	6,569.06	268.81	-6,300.25	credit_card	Instalments	10	☒ approved	☒ credit_card
PqT34ZL67pQW	delivered	PR	4,844.76	98.19	-4,746.57	credit_card	Instalments	3	☒ canceled	☒ debit_card
8kitYsDqalKp	delivered	MG	4,817.67	79.69	-4,737.98	credit_card	Instalments	2	☒ delivered	☒ voucher
HGcdGTihBo5U	delivered	SP	4,840.84	167.10	-4,673.74	credit_card	Single Payment	1	☒ invoiced	☒ wallet
IASpmFgrxfm	delivered	MG	4,659.21	4.38	-4,654.83	credit_card	Instalments	10	☒ processing	Payment Structure
fefqo629MTOH	delivered	MG	4,737.55	125.96	-4,611.59	credit_card	Instalments	2	☒ shipped	☒ Deselect all
8tZzn0Tzuhja	delivered	SP	4,673.09	71.01	-4,602.08	credit_card	Instalments	6	☒ unavailable	☒ Instalments
0M2RBJVmmSwO	delivered	RJ	4,597.45	3.25	-4,594.20	wallet	Single Payment	1		☒ Single Payment
0LwntkvLo9WH	delivered	SC	4,622.36	66.75	-4,555.61	credit_card	Instalments	2		
gPwEfUqQduqM	delivered	SP	4,619.23	87.92	-4,531.31	credit_card	Instalments	3		
blfLPafwhH4s	delivered	ES	4,601.73	96.82	-4,504.91	credit_card	Instalments	3		
Qes3SVLM9AIK	delivered	ES	4,601.73	96.82	-4,504.91	credit_card	Instalments	3		
AO5epMMj34b6	delivered	SP	4,679.36	175.02	-4,504.34	credit_card	Instalments	4		
Total									264886	

Payment Status	Matched					Overpaid					Underpaid				
Order Status	# Orders	Underpaid Value	Overpaid Value	Recorded Payment Value	Recorded Order Value	# Orders	Underpaid Value	Overpaid Value	Recorded Payment Value	Recorded Order Value	# Orders	Underpaid Value	Overpaid Value	Recorded Payment Value	Recorded Order Value
☒ unavailable						2	0.00	1,512.70	1,729.26	216.56					
☒ shipped						406	0.00	124,762.93	186,981.13	62,218.20	530	197,694.83	0.00	72,103.87	269,798.70
☒ wallet						64	0.00	16,857.13	27,040.14	10,183.01	88	29,128.55	0.00	12,141.13	41,269.68
☒ voucher						22	0.00	5,155.02	9,119.92	3,964.90	46	17,422.09	0.00	7,512.07	24,934.16
☒ debit_card						6	0.00	1,064.51	2,220.22	1,155.71	7	4,047.57	0.00	1,163.85	5,211.42
☒ credit_card						314	0.00	101,686.27	148,600.85	46,914.58	389	147,096.62	0.00	51,286.82	198,383.44
☒ processing						127	0.00	33,359.61	50,070.21	16,710.60	146	51,096.06	0.00	17,565.55	68,661.61
☒ invoiced						125	0.00	38,064.90	55,153.50	17,088.60	141	38,087.47	0.00	21,642.35	59,729.82
☒ wallet						38	0.00	14,557.84	20,485.32	5,927.48	33	10,366.93	0.00	3,621.51	13,988.44
☒ voucher						7	0.00	3,250.37	4,794.81	1,544.44	4	1,031.28	0.00	2,017.50	3,048.78
☒ debit_card						2	0.00	730.54	1,357.70	627.16	2	203.43	0.00	136.70	340.13
☒ credit_card						78	0.00	19,526.15	28,515.67	8,989.52	102	26,485.83	0.00	15,866.64	42,352.47
☒ delivered	1	0.00	0.00	145.00	145.00	38595	0.00	10,686,241.47	16,505,580.11	5,819,338.64	48832	20,980,694.95	0.00	6,993,724.43	27,974,419.38
☒ wallet						7421	0.00	2,006,859.62	3,165,350.88	1,158,491.26	9518	4,304,077.11	0.00	1,375,136.05	5,679,213.16
☒ voucher						2052	0.00	782,319.45	1,116,823.87	334,504.42	2738	1,180,670.87	0.00	374,459.17	1,555,130.04
☒ debit_card						543	0.00	135,902.97	212,131.66	76,228.69	721	291,324.11	0.00	98,912.61	390,236.72
☒ credit_card	1	0.00	0.00	145.00	145.00	28579	0.00	7,761,159.43	12,011,273.70	4,250,114.27	35855	15,204,622.86	0.00	5,145,216.60	20,349,839.46
Total	1	0.00	0.00	145.00	145.00	39442	0.00	10,918,311.49	16,859,315.22	5,941,003.73	49873	21,325,997.98	0.00	7,135,925.35	28,461,923.33

Interpretation

The dashboards do not prove that the business has failed to collect revenue. The dataset does not include enough information to confirm whether differences are caused by:

- deposits or partial payments
- instalment mechanics
- refunds or chargebacks
- settlement timing
- credit terms
- external payment provider behaviour
- missing finance ledger data
- data quality or extraction limitations

However, the dashboards do show that **recorded order value and recorded payment value cannot be assumed to reconcile from the available reporting data** - a check for multiple payment records per order returned no duplicate order IDs in the payment table, so the reconciliation issue is not caused by missed payment aggregation.

That is a serious reporting limitation. For management, the issue is not just the size of the gap. It is the lack of visible explanation behind the gap.